46 recommendations, the panel suggested the NSA should no longer store phone data.[1]

The recommendations went further than Obama had said he would be willing to accept. On January 17, 2014, Obama defended the NSA's controversial programs as necessary in the fight against terrorism while acknowledging the outcry over privacy rights. "Threats like terrorism, and proliferation, and cyberattacks are not going away anytime soon, they are going to continue to be a major problem, and for our intelligence community to be effective over the long haul, we must maintain the trust of the American people, and people around the world."[2] In a presidential policy directive, he proposed ending bulk collection of US phone records.

Congressional Response

As early as 2011, two US senators, Ron Wyden and Mark Udall, had been warning the public the US government was using "secret legal interpretations" to use broad surveillance powers the public would be "stunned" to discover.[3] The two Democrats had learned of massive NSA surveillance programs while serving as members on the Senate Intelligence Committee. A few weeks after the first leaked documents were

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